CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 92-094

NPDES NO. CA0079286

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR
CITY OF DOS PALOS
MERCED COUNTY

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

1. The City of Dos Palos (hereafter Discharger) submitted a Report of Waste Discharge, dated 28 May 1991, additional information dated 12 November 1991 and 18 December 1991, and applied for a permit revision to increase the design discharge from 0.54 to 1.2 mgd under the National Pollutant Discharge Elimination System (NPDES).

2. The Discharger presently discharges treated domestic waste from a secondary treatment facility into a drainage ditch (001), which is tributary to the San Joaquin River, waters of the United States, at a point in Section 8, T11S, R12E, MDB&M, as shown on Attachment A, a part of this Order.

3. The Discharger proposes to develop a complete wastewater reclamation operation by 15 November 1992 and go to land disposal. The proposed facility will serve the City of Dos Palos, the Midway Community Services District, and the South Dos Palos County Water District. The system will have capacity for 1.2 mgd and include activated sludge extended aeration, clarification, 54 acres for storage reservoirs and 246 acres for pasture irrigation of non-milking animals and irrigation of fodder, fiber, and seed crops (non-human consumed crops including but not limited to cotton, alfalfa and oat hay). Digested sludge will be dewatered, spread on city-owned farmland, and immediately disced into the soil. The land area used for reclamation is in the SE¼ of Section 8, SW¼ of Section 9, and NE¼ of Section 17, and NW¼ of Section 16, T11S, R12E, MDB&M, as shown on Attachment A.

4. The Assessor's parcel number for the 38.8 acre plant site is 89-01-38; for the 54 acres on which the holding ponds will be located are 89-01-30; and for the 246 acres irrigated farmland are 89-03-15, 89-08-40 and 41. The property is owned by the City.

5. The Report of Waste Discharge describes the effluent discharge as follows:

Average Flow: 0.507 million gallons per day (mgd)
Design Flow: 0.54 mgd, to be increased to 1.2 mgd

Constituent	mg/l	lbs/day
BOD	20	90
Suspended Matter	29	130

6. The U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) and the Board have classified this discharge as a minor discharge.

7. The Board adopted a Water Quality Control Plan, Second Edition, for the Sacramento-San Joaquin River Basin (hereafter Basin Plan) which contains water quality objectives for all waters of the Basin. These requirements implement the Basin Plan.

8. The State Water Resources Control Board adopted the California Inland Surface Waters Plan (Plan) on 11 April 1991. The Plan includes water quality objectives and other requirements. As the Discharger will eliminate the surface water discharge, no provisions are included in this Order to implement the Plan.

9. The beneficial uses of San Joaquin River downstream of the discharge are municipal and domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply; water contact and noncontact recreation; esthetic enjoyment; navigation; ground water recharge, fresh water replenishment; and preservation and enhancement of fish, wildlife and other aquatic resources.

10. The beneficial uses of the underlying ground water are municipal, domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply.

11. The permitted discharge is consistent with the antidegradation provisions of 40 CFR 131.12 and State Water Resources Control Board Resolution 68-16.

12. Effluent limitations, and toxic and pretreatment effluent standards established pursuant to Sections 208(b), 301, 302, 304, and 307 of the Clean Water Act (CWA) and amendments thereto are applicable to the discharge.

13. The discharge is presently governed by Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 90-284 (NPDES No. CA0079286), adopted by the Board on 2 November 1990.

14. The action to adopt an NPDES permit is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) (Public Resources Code Section 21000, et seq.), in accordance with Section 13389 of the California Water Code. In addition, the Farmers Home Administration which is providing financial assistance to the City of Dos Palos has certified a Finding of No Significant Environmental Impact.

15. Storm water leaving the south portion of the treatment plant discharges to a drainage ditch. Storm water leaving the west, north and east portion of the treatment plant discharges to land owned by the City.

16. Federal Regulations for storm water discharge were promulgated by EPA on 16 November 1990 (40 CFR Parts 122, 123, and 124). The regulations require specific categories of facilities, which discharge storm water associated with industrial activity (storm water), to obtain NPDES permits and to

implement Best Available Technology Economically Achievable (BAT) and Best Conventional Pollutant Control Technology (BCT) to reduce or eliminate industrial storm water pollution.

17. The State Water Resources Control Board adopted Order No. 91-13-DWQ (General Permit No. CAS000001) specifying waste discharge requirements for discharge of storm water associated with industrial activities, excluding construction activities, and requiring submittal of a Notice of Intent by industries to be covered under the permit. This Order further specified that if an individual permit is adopted for storm water runoff from a facility, then the General Permit would no longer apply. This individual permit and the provisions it contains concerning storm water relieves the Discharger from seeking coverage under the General Permit.

18. The California Department of Health Services has established statewide reclamation criteria in Title 22, California Code of Regulations, Section 60301, et seq. (hereafter Title 22) for the use of reclaimed water and has developed guidelines for specific uses.

19. The Board consulted with the Department of Health Services, County Health Department, and Mosquito Abatement District and considered their recommendations regarding public health aspects for use of reclaimed water.

20. The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge and has provided them with an opportunity for a public hearing and an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.

21. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

22. This Order shall serve as an NPDES permit pursuant to Section 402 of the CWA, and amendments thereto, and shall take effect upon the date of hearing, provided EPA has no objections.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Order No. 90-284 is rescinded and the City of Dos Palos, its agents, successors and assigns, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, and the provisions of the Clean Water Act and regulations and guidelines adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions:

1. Discharge of treated wastewater at a location or in a manner different from that described in Findings No. 2 and 3 is prohibited.

2. The by-pass or overflow of wastes to surface waters is prohibited, except as allowed by Standard Provision A.13.

3. The discharge of wastewater other than storm water to a drainage ditch is prohibited after 15 November 1992.

B. Effluent Limitations: (Discharge to a drainage ditch until 15 November 1992)

1. Effluent shall not exceed the following limits:

Constituents	Units	Monthly Average	Weekly Average	Monthly Median	Daily Maximum
BOD[1]	mg/l	30	45	--	90
	lbs/day[2]	135	202	--	404
Total Suspended Solids	mg/l	30	45	--	90
	lbs/day[2]	135	202	--	404
Settleable Solids	ml/l	0.2	--	--	1.0
Chlorine Residual	mg/l	--	--	--	0.10
Total Coliform	MPN/100 ml	--	--	23	500

[1] 5-day, 20°C biochemical oxygen demand (BOD)

[2] Based upon a design treatment capacity of 0.54 mgd. At lower flows, the "discharge rate" shall not exceed allowable discharge rates based on actual flows.

2. The arithmetic mean of 20°C BOD (5-day) and total suspended solids in effluent samples collected over a monthly period shall not exceed 15 percent of the arithmetic mean of the values for influent samples collected at approximately the same times during the same period (85 percent removal).

3. The discharge shall not have a pH less than 6.5 nor greater than 8.5.

4. The average dry weather (May through October) discharge flow shall not exceed 0.54 mgd.

C. Discharge Specifications: (Discharge to Ponds and Agricultural Irrigation)

1. The monthly average dry weather discharge flow shall not exceed 1.2 mgd.

2. Objectionable odors originating at this facility shall not be perceivable beyond the limits of the property owned by the Discharger.

3. As a means of discerning compliance with Discharge Specification No. 2, the dissolved oxygen content in the upper zone (1 foot) of wastewater ponds shall not be less than 1.0 mg/l.

4. The dissolved oxygen content of water used for land disposal shall not fall below 1.0 mg/l at the time of application.

5. The treatment facilities shall be designed, constructed, operated, and maintained to prevent inundation or washout due to floods with a 100-year return frequency.

6. The discharge to ponds and the agricultural irrigation area shall not exceed the following limits:

Constituent	Units	Monthly Average	Daily Maximum
BOD_5[1]	mg/l	40	80
Settleable Solids	ml/l	0.2	0.5

[1] Five-day, 20° Celsius biochemical oxygen demand.

7. Ponds shall not have a pH less than 6.0 or greater than 9.0.

8. Ponds and irrigated areas shall be managed to prevent breeding of mosquitos. In particular,

   a. An erosion control program should assure that small coves and irregularities are not created around the perimeter of the water surface.

   b. Weeds shall be minimized through control of water depth, harvesting, or herbicides.

   c. Dead algae, vegetation, and debris shall not accumulate on the water surface.

9. Public contact with wastewater shall be precluded through such means as fences, signs, and other acceptable alternatives.

10. Ponds shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate allowable wastewater flow and design seasonal precipitation and ancillary inflow and infiltration during the nonirrigation season. Design seasonal precipitation shall be based on total annual precipitation using a return period of 100 years, distributed monthly in accordance with historical rainfall patterns. Freeboard shall never be less than two feet (measured vertically).

11. On or about 1 October of each year, available pond storage capacity, shall at least equal the volume necessary to comply with Discharge Specification No. 10.

12. Use of reclaimed water shall be limited to pasture irrigation of non-milking animals, and irrigation of fodder, fiber and seed crops (non-human consumed crops including but not limited to cotton, alfalfa and oat hay).

13. Public contact with reclaimed water shall be precluded through such means as fences, signs, and irrigation management practices.

14. Reclaimed water for irrigation shall be managed to minimize erosion, runoff, and movement of aerosols from the disposal area.

15. Application of reclaimed wastewater to the reclamation area shall be at reasonable rates considering the crop, soil, climate, and irrigation management system. The nutrient loading of the reclamation area, including the nutritive value of organic and chemical fertilizers and of the reclaimed water, shall not exceed the crop demand.

16. The following setback distances/buffer zones shall be provided at the reclamation site:

a.

<u>Pond and Surface Irrigated Areas</u>	<u>To</u>
25'	Property line
100'	On-site irrigation wells
500'	Domestic wells
100'	On-site and off-site food crop fields
70'	Drainage courses

D. Sludge Disposal:

1. Collected screenings, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner that is consistent with Chapter 15 and approved by the Executive Officer.

2. Any proposed change in sludge use or disposal practice shall be reported to the Executive Officer at least 90 days in advance of the change.

3. Use and disposal of sewage sludge shall comply with existing federal and state laws and regulations, and with Clean Water Act (CWA) Section 405(d) technical standards when promulgated.

   If an applicable management practice or numerical limitation for pollutants in sewage sludge is promulgated under Section 405(d) of the

CWA after issuance of this permit which is more stringent than the sludge pollutant limit or management practice specified in this permit or in existing federal or state laws or regulations, the Discharger shall comply with the limitations by not later than the compliance deadline specified in the applicable regulations as required by Section 405(d) of the CWA.

4. The Discharger is encouraged to comply with the State Guidance Manual issued by the Department of Health Services titled *Manual of Good Practice for Landspreading of Sewage Sludge*.

E. Ground Water Limitations:

The discharge, in combination with other sources, shall not cause underlying ground water to:

1. Be degraded.

2. Contain chemicals, heavy metals, or trace elements in concentrations that adversely affect beneficial uses or exceed maximum contaminant levels specified in 22 CCR, Division 4, Chapter 15.

3. Contain taste or odor-producing substances in concentrations that cause nuisance or adversely affect beneficial uses.

4. Contain concentrations of chemical constituents in amounts that adversely affect agricultural use.

F. Receiving Water Limitations:

Receiving Water Limitations are based upon water quality objectives contained in the Basin Plan. As such, they are a required part of this permit.

The discharge shall not cause the following in the receiving water:

1. Concentrations of dissolved oxygen to fall below 5.0 mg/l.

2. Oils, greases, waxes, or other materials to form a visible film or coating on the water surface or on the stream bottom.

3. Oils, greases, waxes, floating material (liquids, solids, foams, and scums) or suspended material to create a nuisance or adversely affect beneficial uses.

4. Toxic substances in concentrations that produce detrimental physiological responses in human, plant, animal, or aquatic life.

5. Chlorine to be detected in the receiving water.

6. Esthetically undesirable discoloration.

7. Fungi, slimes, or other objectionable growths.

8. Turbidity to increase more than 20 percent over background levels.

9. The normal ambient pH to fall below 6.5, exceed 8.5, or change by more than 0.5 units.

10. Deposition of material that causes nuisance or adversely affects beneficial uses.

11. The normal ambient temperature to be altered more than 5°F.

12. Taste or odor-producing substances to impart undesirable tastes or odors to fish flesh or other edible products of aquatic origin or to cause nuisance or adversely affect beneficial uses.

13. Violation of any applicable water quality standard for receiving waters adopted by the Board or the State Water Resources Control Board pursuant to the CWA and regulations adopted thereunder.

G. Provisions:

1. The Discharger shall not allow pollutant-free wastewater to be discharged into the collection, treatment, and disposal system in amounts that significantly diminish the system's capability to comply with this Order. Pollutant-free wastewater means rainfall, ground water, cooling waters, and condensates that are essentially free of pollutants.

2. Within **90 days** of adoption of this Order, the Discharger will submit for approval by the Executive Officer, a report detailing a plan and time schedule for monitoring any impact on ground water from wastewater storage and disposal practices. The report should be prepared by a registered engineer or engineering geologist.

3. The Discharger shall submit a Storm Water Pollution Prevention Plan within **four months** after adoption of this Order, and implement the Plan upon approval.

4. The Discharger shall comply with the following time schedule to assure compliance with Discharge Prohibition A.3 of this Order:

Task	Compliance Date	Report Due
Construction 50% Complete	15 Jul 92	3 Aug 92
Full Compliance	15 Nov 92	30 Nov 92

The Discharger shall submit to the Board on or before each compliance report date, a report detailing compliance or noncompliance with the specific schedule date and task. If noncompliance is being reported, the reasons for such noncompliance shall be stated, plus an estimate of the date when the Discharger will be in compliance. The Discharger shall notify the Board by letter when it returns to compliance with the time schedule.

5. The Discharger shall use the best practicable cost-effective control technique currently available to limit mineralization to no more than a reasonable increment.

6. The Discharger shall comply with all the items of the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements (NPDES)", dated 1 March 1991, which are part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are referred to as "Standard Provision(s)". [For surface water discharge]

7. The Discharger shall comply with all the items of the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements", dated 1 March 1991, which are part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are referred to as "Standard Provision(s)". [Effective when surface water discharge is terminated]

8. The Discharger shall comply with Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 92-094, which is a part of this Order, and any revisions thereto as ordered by the Executive Officer.

9. This Order expires on **1 May 1997** and the Discharger must file a Report of Waste Discharge in accordance with Title 23, CCR, not later than 180 days in advance of such date in application for renewal of waste discharge requirements, if it wishes to continue the discharge.

10. The Discharger shall implement, as more completely set forth in 40 CFR 403.5, the necessary legal authorities, programs, and controls to ensure that the following incompatible wastes are not introduced to the treatment system, where incompatible wastes are:

    b. Wastes which create a fire or explosion hazard in the treatment works;

    c. Wastes which will cause corrosive structural damage to treatment works, but in no case wastes with a pH lower than 5.0, unless the works is specially designed to accommodate such wastes;

    d. Solid or viscous wastes in amounts which cause obstruction to flow in sewers, or which cause other interference with proper operation or treatment works;

e. Any waste, including oxygen demanding pollutants (BOD, etc.), released in such volume or strength as to cause inhibition or disruption in the treatment works, and subsequent treatment process upset and loss of treatment efficiency; and

f. Heat in amounts that inhibit or disrupt biological activity in the treatment works, or that raise influent temperatures above 40°C (104°F), unless the treatment works is designed to accommodate such heat.

g. Petroleum oil, nonbiodegradable cutting oil, or products of mineral oil origin in amounts that will cause interference or pass through;

h. Pollutants which result in the presence of toxic gases, vapors, or fumes within the treatment works in a quantity that may cause acute worker health and safety problems;

i. Any trucked or hauled pollutants, except at points predesignated by the Discharger.

11. The Discharger shall implement, as more completely set forth in 40 CFR 403.5, the legal authorities, programs, and controls necessary to ensure that indirect discharges do not introduce pollutants into the sewerage system that, either alone or in conjunction with a discharge or discharges from other sources:

a. Flow through the system to the receiving water in quantities or concentrations that cause a violation of this Order, or

b. Inhibit or disrupt treatment processes, treatment system operations, or sludge processes, use, or disposal and either cause a violation of this Order or prevent sludge use or disposal in accord with this Order.

12. Prior to making any change in the discharge point, place of use, or purpose of use of the wastewater, the Discharger shall obtain approval of or clearance from the State Water Resources Control Board (Division of Water Quality and Water Rights).

13. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities presently owned or controlled by the Discharger, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to this office.

I, WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 29 May 1992.

William H. Crooks
WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

AMENDED KDL:JED:SPD:dlk

Attachments

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 92-094

NPDES NO. CA0079286

FOR
CITY OF DOS PALOS
MERCED COUNTY

Specific sample station locations shall be established under direction of the Board's staff, and a description of the stations shall be attached to this Order.

INFLUENT MONITORING

Samples shall be collected at approximately the same time as effluent samples and should be representative of the influent for the period sampled. The following shall constitute the influent monitoring program:

Constituent	Units	Type of Sample	Sampling Frequency
20°C BOD_5	mg/l, lbs/day	8-hr. Composite	Weekly
Suspended Solids	mg/l, lbs/day	8-hr. Composite	Weekly
Flow	mgd	Continuous	Daily
Settleable Matter	ml/l	Grab	Daily

EFFLUENT MONITORING

(When discharging to a drainge ditch)

Effluent samples shall be collected downstream from the last connection through which wastes can be admitted into the outfall. Effluent samples should be representative of the volume and quality of the discharge. Samples collected from the outlet structure of ponds will be considered adequately composited. Time of collection of samples shall be recorded. Effluent monitoring shall include at least the following:

Constituents	Units	Type of Sample	Sampling Frequency
20°C BOD_5	mg/l, lbs/day	8-hr. Composite	Weekly
Suspended Matter	mg/l, lbs/day	8-hr. Composite	Weekly
Settleable Matter	ml/l	Grab	Daily
Specific Conductivity @25C	μmhos/cm	Grab	Daily

Constituents	Units	Type of Sample	Sampling Frequency
pH	Number	Grab	Daily
Total Coliform Organisms	MPN/100 ml	Grab	Weekly
Chlorine Residual	mg/l	Grab	Daily
Flow	mgd	Cumulative	Daily

If the discharge is intermittent rather than continuous, then on the first day of each such intermittent discharge, the Discharger shall monitor and record data for all of the constituents listed above, after which the frequencies of analysis given in the schedule shall apply for the duration of each such intermittent discharge. In no event shall the Discharger be required to monitor and record data more often than twice the frequencies listed in the schedule.

RECEIVING WATER MONITORING

(When discharging wastewater other than storm water to a drainage ditch)

All receiving water samples shall be grab samples. Receiving water monitoring shall include at least the following:

Station	Description
R-1	100 feet upstream from the point of discharge
R-2	100 feet downstream from the point of discharge

Constituent	Units	Station	Sampling Frequency
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/l	R-1, R-2	Weekly
pH	Number	R-1, R-2	Weekly
Specific Conductance	μmhos/cm	R-1, R-2	Weekly

In conducting the receiving water sampling, a log shall be kept of the receiving water conditions throughout the reach bounded by Stations R-1 and R-2. Attention shall be given to the presence or absence of:

a. Floating or suspended matter
b. Discoloration
c. Bottom deposits
d. Aquatic life

Notes on receiving water conditions shall be summarized in the monitoring report.

MONITORING OF PONDS AND WASTEWATER BEING USED FOR IRRIGATION

The following shall constitute the pond monitoring program and monitoring of wastewater going to irrigation. Samples collected at the outlet structure of ponds will be considered composited, and representative of wastewater being used for irrigation.

Constituents	Units	Type of Sample	Sampling Frequency
20°C BOD_5	mg/l	8-hr. Composite	Weekly
Settleable Solids	ml/l	Grab	Weekly
pH	Number	Grab	Weekly
~~Total Coliform Organisms~~	~~MPN/100 ml~~	~~Grab~~	~~Weekly~~ WB
Specific Conductivity @ 25°C	µmhos/cm	Grab	Weekly
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/l	Grab	Weekly (each pond)
Pond Freeboard	feet	--	Monthly (each pond)
Flow	mgd	Cumulative	Daily

WATER SUPPLY MONITORING

A sampling station shall be established where a representative sample of the municipal water supply can be obtained. Water supply monitoring shall include at least the following:

Constituents	Units	Sampling Frequency
Specific Conductivity @ 25°C	µmhos/cm	Monthly

STORM WATER MONITORING

Storm water samples shall be collected twice during the rainy season (Oct - March). The first sampling event shall be taken from the first significant rain storm of the season with the second coming from any other significant storm later in the rainy season. Storm water monitoring shall include at least the following:

Constituents	Units
Estimate of flow	cfs
pH	pH Units

Constituents	Units
Suspended Solids	mg/l, lbs/day
20°C BOD_5	mg/l
Specific Conductivity	μmhos/cm

REPORTING

In reporting the monitoring data, the Discharger shall arrange the data in tabular form so that the date, the constituents, and the concentrations are readily discernible. The data shall be summarized in such a manner to illustrate clearly the compliance with waste discharge requirements.

Monthly monitoring reports shall be submitted to the Regional Board by the **15th day** of the following month.

The results of any monitoring done more frequently than required at the locations specified in the Monitoring and Reporting Program shall be reported to the Board.

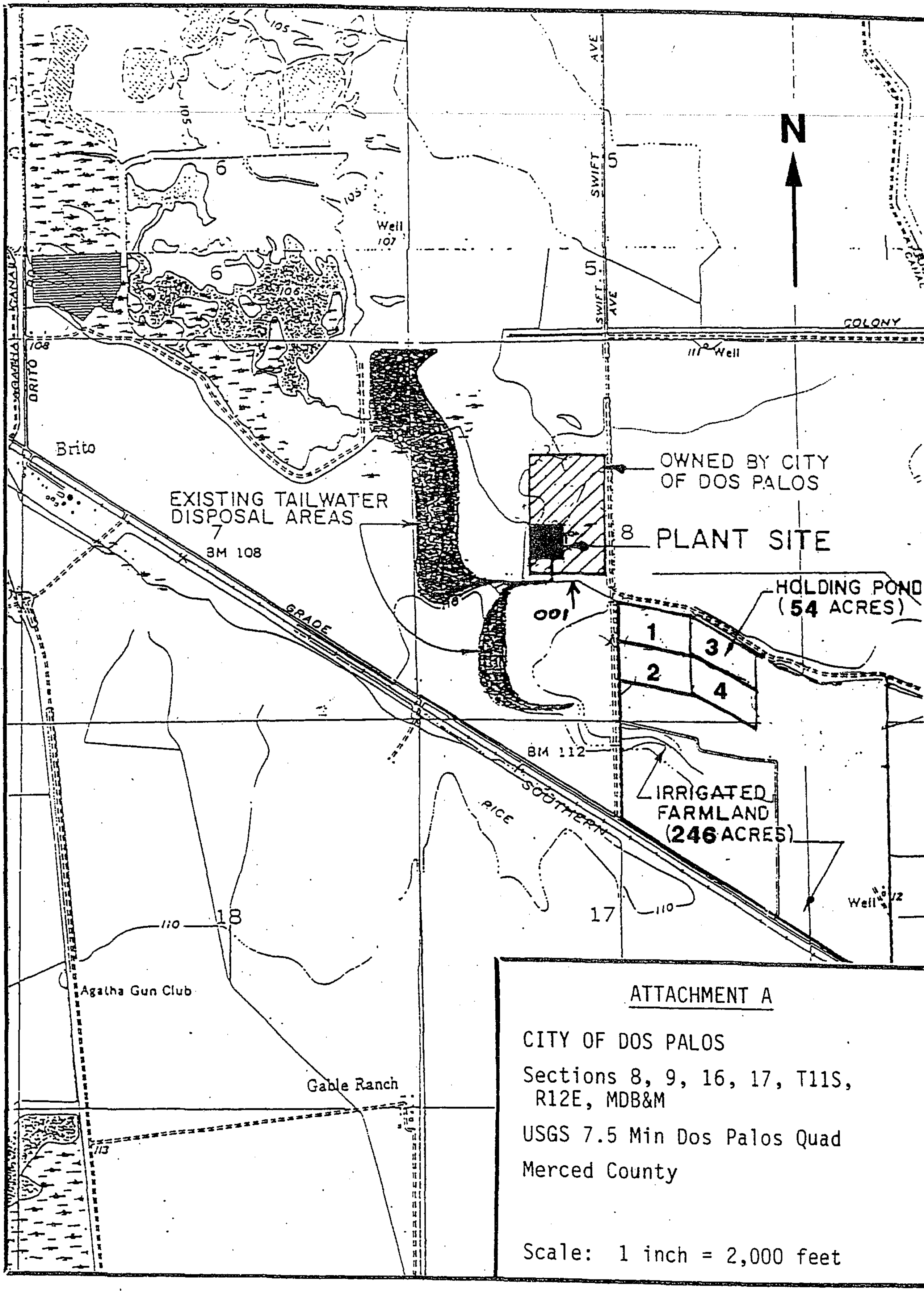
Upon written request of the Board, the Discharger shall submit a report to the Board by **30 January** of each year. The report shall contain both tabular and graphical summaries of the monitoring data obtained during the previous year. In addition, the Discharger shall discuss the compliance record and the corrective actions taken or planned which may be needed to bring the discharge into full compliance with the waste discharge requirements.

The Discharger shall implement the above monitoring program on the first day of the month following effective date of this Order.

Ordered by William H. Crooks
WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

29 May 1992
(Date)

AMENDED KDL:JED:SPD:dlk



ATTACHMENT A

CITY OF DOS PALOS

Sections 8, 9, 16, 17, T11S, R12E, MDB&M

USGS 7.5 Min Dos Palos Quad

Merced County

Scale: 1 inch = 2,000 feet

INFORMATION SHEET

CITY OF DOS PALOS
MERCED COUNTY

The City of Dos Palos presently operates a wastewater treatment facility in the SW¼ of Section 8, T11S, R12E, MDB&M. The facility serves the City of Dos Palos and the Midway Community Services District. Discharges from the facility have previously been governed by Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 90-284 (NPDES No. CA0079286), adopted 2 November 1990.

The present facility provides biological treatment using activated sludge extended aeration followed by clarification and chlorination. The system is designed to treat an average flow of 0.54 mgd and presently discharges the treated effluent to a drainage ditch, which is tributary to the San Joaquin River system.

The City is working on development of a complete wastewater reclamation operation, which is scheduled for completion in November 1992, and go to land disposal. The proposed facility will serve the City of Dos Palos, the Midway Community Services District, and the South Dos Palos County Water District. The proposed facility will accommodate a design flow of 1.2 mgd and include an expanded activated sludge extended aeration system followed by clarifiers, 54 acres for four storage ponds, and 246 acres for irrigation of pasture for non-milking animals, and irrigation of fodder, fiber, and seed crops (non-human consumed crops, including but not limited to, cotton, alfalfa and oat hay). Sludge will be digested and spread on City-owned farmland. The holding ponds will store effluent during the winter months and between irrigation cycles. The recently acquired land for reclamation is in the SE¼ of Section 8, SW¼ of Section 9, NE¼ of Section 17 and NW¼ of Section 16, T11S, R12E, MDB&M.

Local surface waters are also local drainages into interconnecting marshy areas which generally contain rough fish and are not considered to be a significant fishery resource. Large sections of the area are used as duck clubs and the lands may be flooded during duck hunting season. The areas may be used for cattle grazing and local waters used for livestock watering. Further down the drainage system, these surplus waters can be used for marginal agricultural purposes.

Ground water in the immediate area can generally be found at depths of less than 4 to 10 feet. The quality of the perched water is very poor with specific conductances ranging from 28,000 to 50,000 micromhos. Ground water below the perched aquifer has conductivities ranging between 1,300 and 1,900 μmhos/cm. The depth to the unconfined aquifer is approximately 180 to 195 feet. The shallow ground water is unsuitable for any known beneficial uses; however, the deeper supply is used for domestic and agricultural purposes.

The native soil material of the area is generally fine textured, slowly permeable surface material varying from approximately four to five feet in depth, underlain by a thick strata of moderately to rapidly permeable alluvium.

This permit will cover their treated waste effluent discharge, wastewater going to irrigation, and storm water discharge.

The action to adopt an NPDES Permit is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (Public Resources Code Section 21000, et seq.), in accordance with the California Water Code. However, the Farmers Home Administration, who is providing financial assistance for the project, has certified a Finding of No Significant Environmental Impact.

2 June 1992:KDL:JED:SPD:dlk